

Mobile Developer Community Meetup

JUNE 10, 2026



Connected
Services BC

Land acknowledgment

I would like to acknowledge the land on which I am privileged to work, live and recreate on is the traditional territory of the Malahat people.

Agenda

DevX Updates

Apple and Google Updates

Mobile Developer Community Survey Results

Presentation: Real-Device Mobile Testing at Scale by Kjartan Einarsson

Updates



DevX Updates

- The mobile developer community is now in MS Teams [MobileDevelopment-howto](#)
 - Connect with other mobile app teams
 - Get announcements from DevX on mobile app related issues
 - Is this channel for me?
 - Yes, anyone involved or interested in mobile apps in BC Government is welcome to join

Apple Updates

- Device Auditing - Completed
 - Devices that were registered in 2020 or before have been disabled
 - Devices that weren't associated with a name have been disabled
 - Contact DevX team if you need a device re-enabled
- Apple Developer program was renewed in April and is valid until April 14, 2027.
- WWDC – check for Apple announcements/updates

Google Updates – Developer Verification Update

Starting in September 2026, Android apps must be registered to a developer with a verified identity to be installed by users on certified Android devices.

Developer identity verification - complete

Automatic Package registration - completed in March

No further action is needed

Learn more at: <https://developer.android.com/developer-verification>

Questions?

Mobile Developer Community Survey Results



**The community meetup will
remain as a standalone –
quarterly meetup**



Standalone vs combined meetup

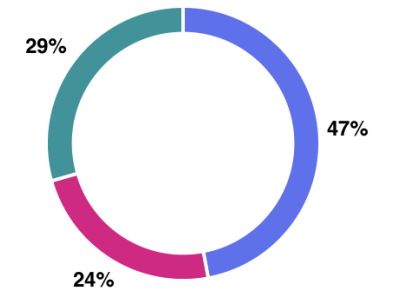
- 17 responses
- 5 had no preference
- 2:1 that had a preference chose a standalone meeting

The meetup will remain a standalone meetup

2. Which do you prefer for the Mobile Developer Community Meetup?

[More details](#)

• A standalone meeting	8
• Combine it with the Cloud Services Community Meetup	4
• I have no preference	5



Meetup frequency

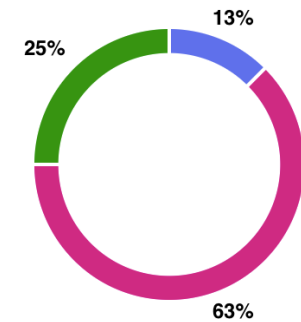
- 8 responses
- 2 had no preference
- 5/6 that had a preference chose “Quarterly”

The meetup will remain as a quarterly meetup

3. How often would you like the Mobile Developer Community Meetup to happen as a stand-alone meeting?

[More details](#)

Monthly	1
Quarterly (4 times a year)	5
Twice a year	0
Once a year	0
I have no preference	2



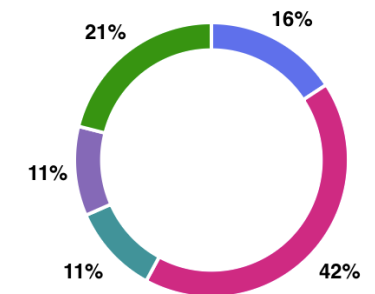
About the community

- 17 responses
- Developer is the largest role
- But 9/17 responses were non-developer role
- “Other” responses included:
 - Project Stewardship (1)
 - Security (2)
 - DevOps (1)
- response allowed multiple roles
 - Were some people with multiple roles

1. What is your role within your mobile app team? (You can select more than 1 role if that is the case)

[More details](#)

Product Owner	3
Developer	8
QA	2
Customer Support	2
Other	4

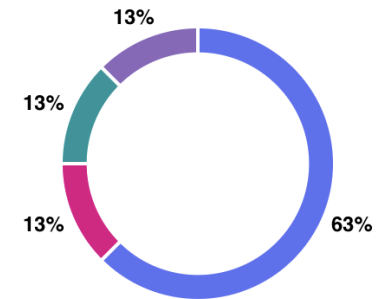


Meetup attendance

- 8 responses
- Most (5/8) attend all the meetings
- But have people that attend sometimes, rarely or it was their first meeting

4. How often do you attend the meetups?

● I go to all the meetings (4 a year)	5
● I go to some of the meetings (2-3 a year)	1
● I rarely go to the meetings (0-1 a year)	1
● This would be the first time I attend one	1



[More details](#)

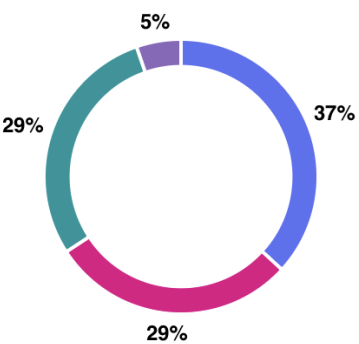
Meeting feedback

- Question 5
 - 15 responses
 - Multi-select answer
 - Other responses included:
 - Hearing other team’s perspectives
 - Not actively involved with app development - just support users
- Question 6
 - 1 response
 - More presentations!

5. What do you find beneficial about the Mobile Developer Community Meetup?

[More details](#)

• Updates about Apple and Google programs	14
• Presentations	11
• Connect with other mobile app teams	11
• Other	2



6. What could be improved about the Mobile Developer Community Meetup?

[More details](#)

1
Responses

Latest Responses
...

Meeting topics

6 responses:

- CI/CD, automated builds - 3
- AI / On-Device AI (Edge AI) - 2
- Libraries, tools, tech stacks – 2
- Examples of what other teams are doing – 2
- Unit testing - 1
- Security – 1
- Innovations - 1

7. What topics would you like covered at future meetings?

[More details](#)

6

Responses

Latest Responses

"I like hearing about what others are doing - it's very helpful to understand a..."

...

2 respondents (33%) answered AI for this question.

Automated builds
tech stacks
Edge AI
AI models
CD
AI
unit testing
libraries/frameworks
CI
App
example projects

Meeting topics

Contact the DevX Team if you would like to present one of these topics

Developer.Experience@gov.bc.ca

Questions?

Or thoughts. Or pushback. Or things we missed.

Presentation: Real-Device Mobile Testing at Scale

BY KJARTAN EINARSSON

Real-Device Mobile Testing at Scale

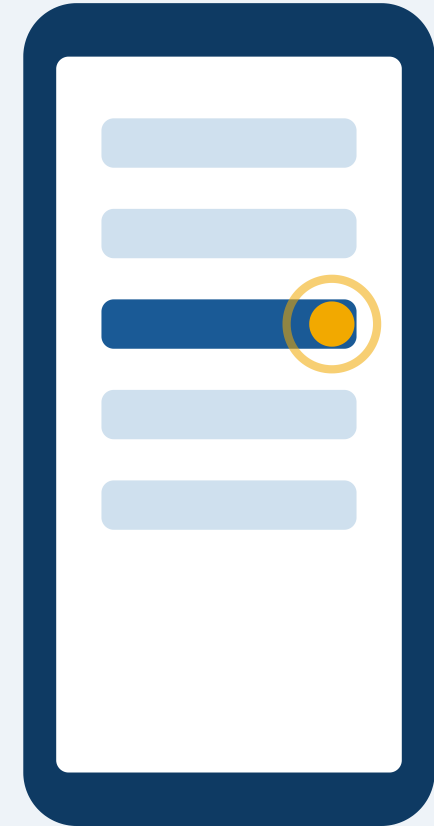
with Sauce Labs

Kjartan Einarsson — BCSC Mobile, Connected Services BC
Gov Mobile Developer Community · June 10, 2026

What we're talking about

- The **BC Services Card app** — how people prove who they are to access government services
- **End-to-end (e2e) testing** — software that drives the app like a real person would: *tap by tap, screen by screen*
- Today: **what** we automated, **why Sauce Labs**, what works, what doesn't, and a **live run on a real device**

End-to-end



Driven like a user

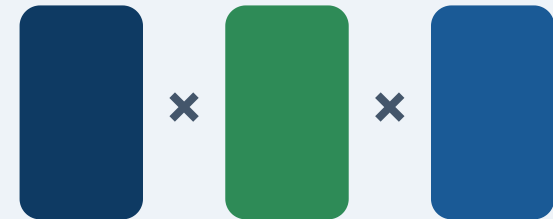
tap by tap, screen by screen

Testing a mobile app by hand doesn't scale

- Every release, someone re-runs the whole journey **by hand**
- Times **iOS and Android**, times multiple OS versions, times device types
- **Slow** (a day or more), easy to **miss** things, hard to **repeat** exactly



Slow & manual



iOS × Android × OS versions

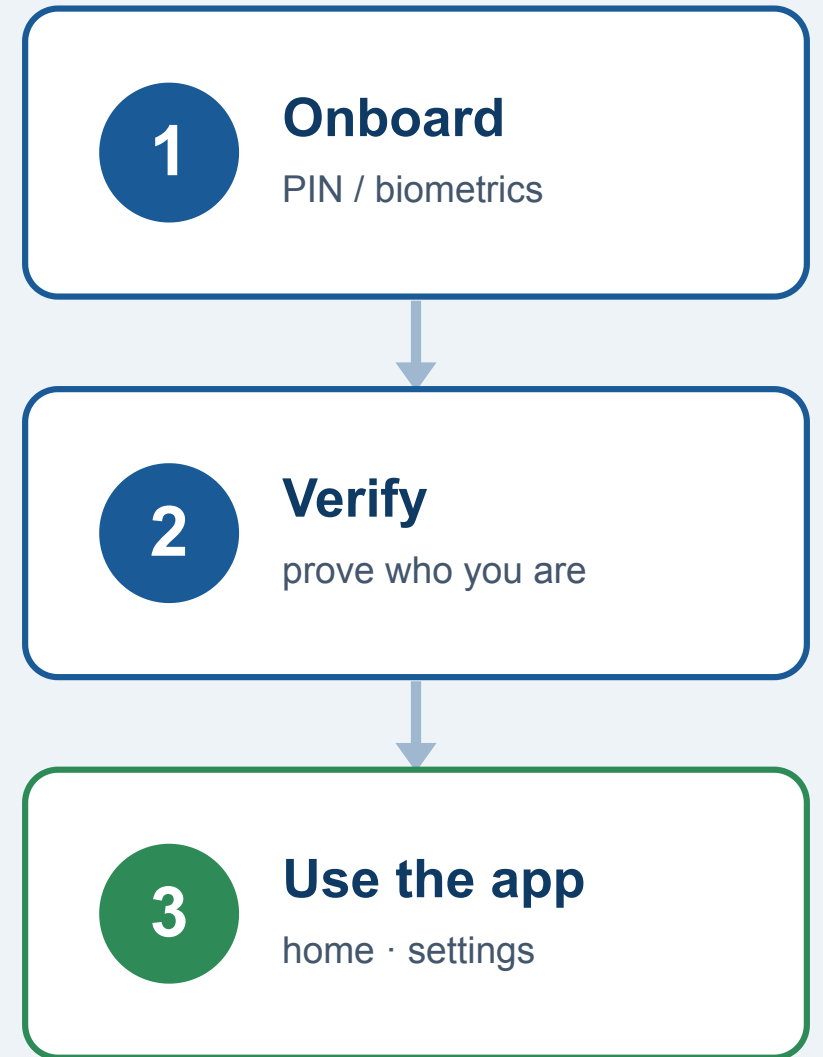
...every release, by hand

What we test: the real user journey

- **Onboarding** — set up the app, PIN / biometrics
- **Identity verification** — scan your card, prove who you are
- **Using the app** — navigation, settings, account

Automated today; a few flows still being finished.

The user journey



we automate the whole path

Why Sauce Labs

- **Real iPhones and Android phones** in the cloud — not just emulators
- No device lab to **buy or maintain**
- Run **many devices / OS versions in parallel**
- Every run is **recorded** — video + logs to debug

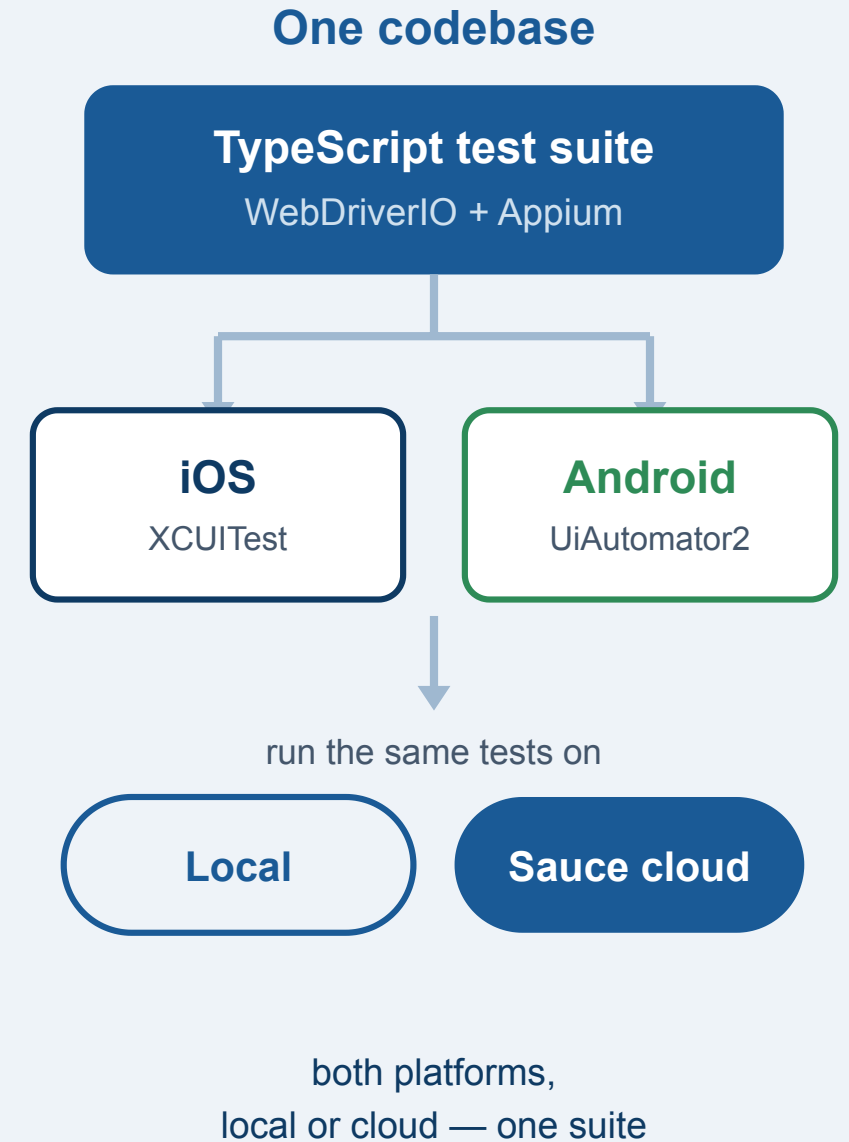


Real iPhones & Androids

on demand, in parallel

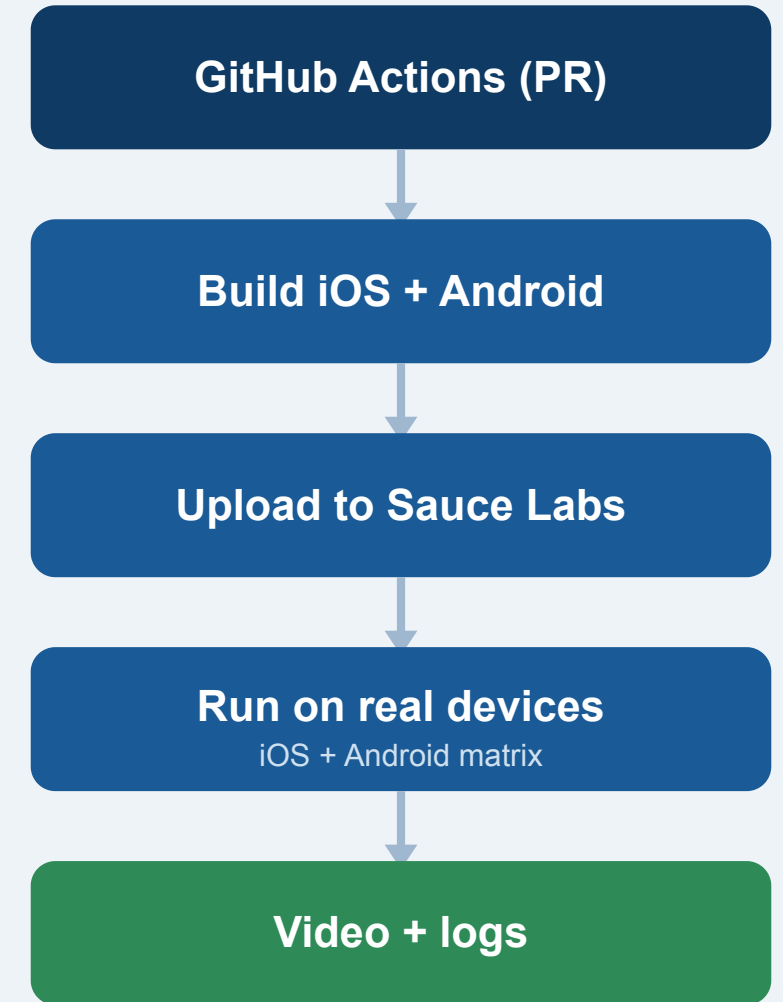
One codebase, both platforms

- **WebDriverIO + Appium + TypeScript**
- Config-driven: the *same* tests run **locally** or on **Sauce Labs**, iOS and Android
- **Screen-object pattern** + one shared **typed test-ID registry** → cross-platform and maintainable



How it runs in CI

- **GitHub Actions** builds the iOS and Android apps
- Uploads them to **Sauce Labs**
- **Smoke tests on every pull request** — fast feedback
- **Full regression nightly** — ~43 min, both platforms
- Failures → full **session video + logs** in the dashboard

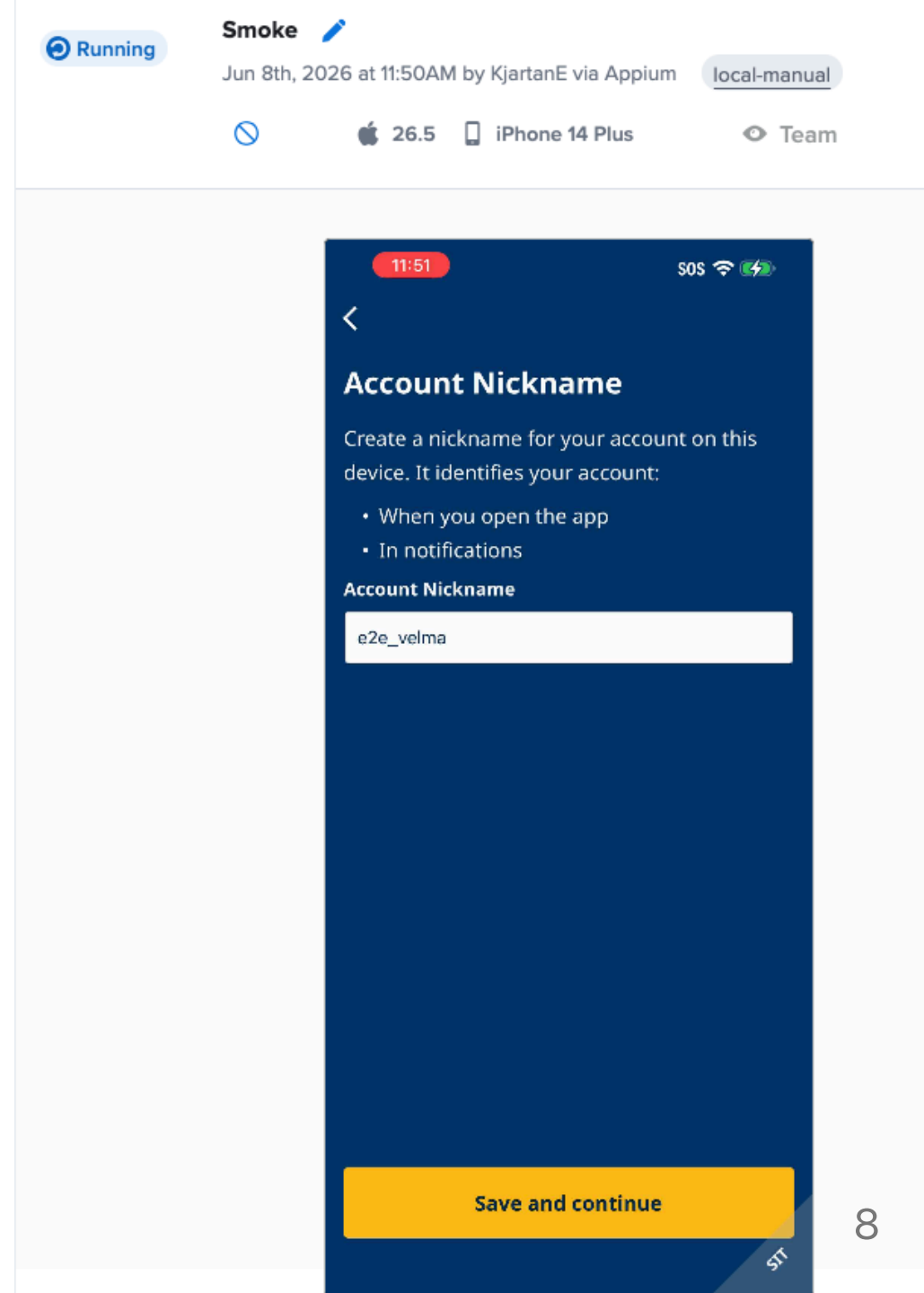


smoke on every PR ·
full regression nightly



A happy-path journey on a real device

onboarding → verify identity → into the app



What works well

- The full journey — onboarding through to the home screen — runs on **real iOS + Android devices**, in CI, **unattended and repeatable**
- The **same flows run every time** — no human variance, nothing forgotten
- Exactly what you just watched: a real phone, driven end to end

What works



Unattended · repeatable

same flows, every run

Where Sauce fell short #1 — camera injection

- The idea: **inject a digital card image** so the app's scanner "sees" the barcode — no physical card
- Clever: Sauce swaps the camera feed at the **native layer**
- In practice: **flaky**, and it **crashes the app intermittently**
- Not reliable enough to depend on → the suite **types the serial number by hand** instead

Camera injection



Flaky · crashes

we type the serial by hand
instead

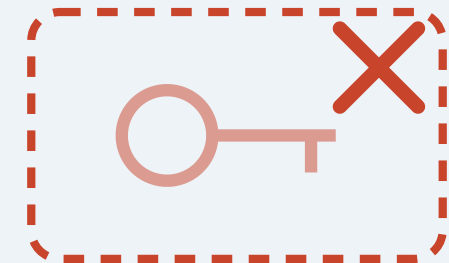
Where Sauce fell short #2 — biometrics

- Sauce intercepts the biometric call and **replays "success"**
- But our app does **real secure work** behind it — a **token in the keychain**
- Sauce's keychain coverage **doesn't include that token type** → the app *thinks* it passed, then the token **isn't there** and fails later
- **Biometric-gated flows aren't testable on Sauce today**

Biometrics



Sauce replays "approved"



...token never created

app fails later

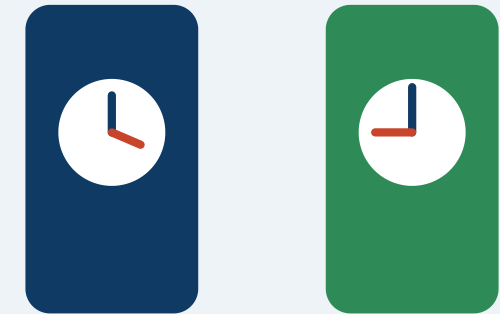
The real-world gotchas

- **IP whitelisting, with a twist:** we had to allow the **GitHub Actions runner** IPs — *not* Sauce Labs'. Sauce only streams the device; the **runner** makes the calls.
- **Cloud devices vary:** speed and timing differ run to run → lean on stable test IDs and defensive waits, not fixed sleeps

Real-world gotchas



whitelist the **runner's** IP
(not Sauce Labs')

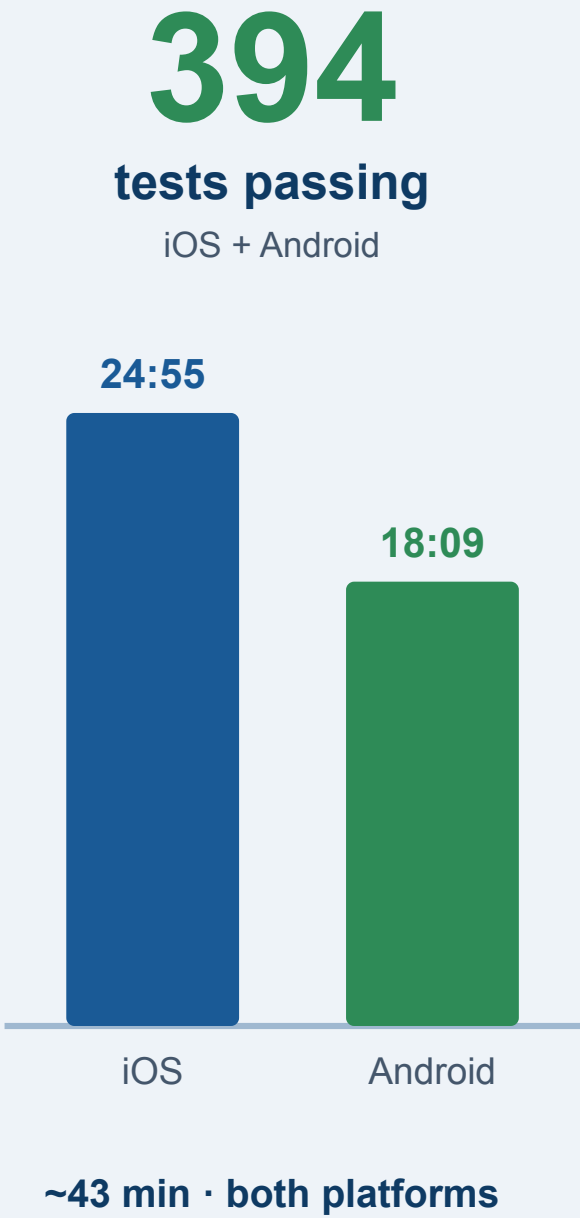


cloud devices vary in speed
→ stable IDs + defensive waits

From a day of manual QA → ~43 minutes

Platform	Tests	Time
iOS	197 passing	24:55
Android	197 passing	18:09
Both	394 passing	43:04

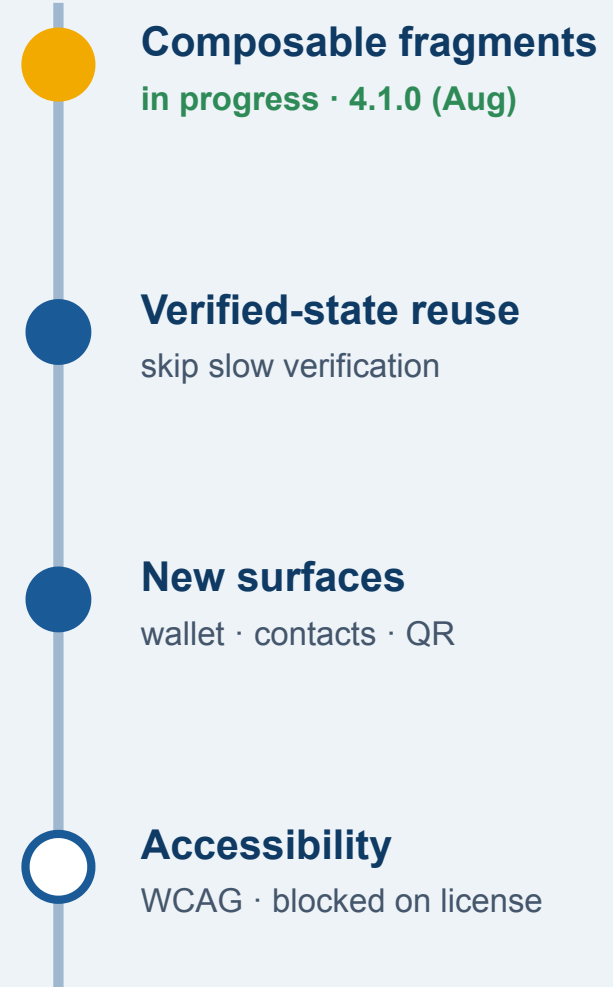
Same checks, every run, on real devices.



What's next

- **4.1.0 restructure (in progress, Aug release):** tests are **composable fragments** — the import list *is* the test plan
- **Verified-state reuse:** the app reaches Home **without** verifying first → set up once, reuse it, skip slow verification
- **New surfaces:** wallet, contacts, scan / QR, deep-link
- **Accessibility (Deque axe)** in CI — WCAG (*blocked on license*)

What's next



 **Back to the demo**

the run · the session recording · the dashboard

 Search by name

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 My organization ▾



Monday, Jun 8th

 Passed

E2E smoke - Android

Jun 8th, 2026 at 11:53AM by jason_bcgov via Appium

build-6697

 Passed

E2E smoke - iOS

Jun 8th, 2026 at 11:52AM by jason_bcgov via Appium

build-6697

 Errored

Smoke

Jun 8th, 2026 at 11:50AM by KjartanE via Appium

local-manual

 Passed

E2E smoke - iOS

Jun 8th, 2026 at 11:26AM by jason_bcgov via Appium

build-6697

 Passed

E2E smoke - iOS

Jun 8th, 2026 at 11:14AM by jason_bcgov via Appium

build-6696

 Passed

E2E smoke - Android

Jun 8th, 2026 at 11:13AM by jason_bcgov via Appium

15
build-6696

Thank you — questions?

Kjartan Einarsson · BCSC Mobile

*Happy to share what we learned — the wins and the
rough edges*



Thank you

questions welcome

Next Meetup

September 9th at 1pm

Please contact the Developer Experience team if you would like to present!

Developer Experience Team

Email

Developer.Experience@gov.bc.ca

Mobile Developer Community

MS Teams

[MobileDevelopment-howto](#)